

YEAR 10 (AFTER PREP) · THEME 3 · AMAZING STORIES

Reading

B1+/B2

The Shepherd Who Read the Sky · The Letter That Found Its Way Home

Hazırlık Sonrası 10. Sınıf

Name – Surname

Class

No

Date

Aim Understand the main idea and details, make inferences and connect the text to your own life.

1 Before you read

Make predictions before you read.

1. Look at the title. What do you think 'read the sky' might mean?
2. Do you know any true stories about someone who taught themselves a skill?

The Shepherd Who Read the Sky

- 1 By the age of twelve, Yusuf could already name every visible star from his family's hillside in eastern Anatolia. There was no telescope, no astronomy club, and, at first, barely any books — just long nights spent watching the sky while his family's sheep grazed nearby. What began as a way to pass the time slowly turned into something far more serious.
- 2 At sixteen, Yusuf was able to build his first basic telescope from spare lenses he found at a market by chance. It was fairly crude, and villagers were slightly amused by the strange contraption pointed at the night sky. Yet within two years, he had taught himself enough physics and mathematics, entirely self-taught from borrowed textbooks, to win a national science competition — a result that surprised everyone except, quietly, Yusuf himself.
- 3 Today, Yusuf works at an observatory, and he says he still isn't fully used to being called a scientist. 'At a glance, my story might sound like pure luck,' he explains, 'but really it was years of determination that nobody saw.' His journey shows that a breakthrough can begin anywhere — even on a quiet hillside, under a sky full of ordinary stars.

197 words

2 While you read

5 × 2 pts

Circle the correct option.

1. What is the main idea of the text?
☐ a Yusuf became a scientist purely by luck.
☐ b Persistent self-teaching turned a shepherd's hobby into a scientific achievement.
☐ c Telescopes are only useful in villages.
 2. Yusuf found the spare lenses for his first telescope _____.
 3. How did Yusuf learn the physics and mathematics he needed?
☐ a At a private science academy ☐ b Entirely self-taught, from borrowed textbooks
☐ c From a family member who was a scientist
 4. According to the text, Yusuf now feels completely comfortable being called a scientist.
☐ Correct ☐ Incorrect
-
5. Yusuf believes his story was really about years of _____ that nobody saw, not just luck.

3 After you read*Write short answers. Then compare with a partner.*

1. What degree modifiers can you find in the text? What do they tell you about how the villagers or Yusuf felt?

2. Do you think persistence matters more than natural talent? Why or why not?

1 Before you read*Make predictions before you read.*

1. What do you think 'the letter that found its way home' might refer to?

2. Have you ever heard of a friendship that began completely by accident?

The Letter That Found Its Way Home

- 1 In 1987, a woman named Sibel wrote a letter to a pen pal whose address she had copied down slightly incorrectly. The letter should have been lost forever. Instead, by an extraordinary

coincidence, it was delivered to a stranger living at almost the exact same street number in a different city — and that stranger, fascinated rather than annoyed, decided to write back.

- 2 What followed was an absolutely remarkable, decades-long friendship built entirely on letters, and later, emails. The two women were never able to meet in person for over thirty years; work, distance and, at times, simply bad timing kept getting in the way. Then, in the end, a chance business trip finally brought them to the same city at the same time.
- 3 'At a glance, it seems like an ordinary mistake with an unlikely result,' Sibel says now. 'But by the time we finally met, we were used to knowing everything about each other's lives — we just hadn't seen each other's faces yet.' Their story has since been shared thousands of times online, proving that even a small accident can, by chance, turn into something extraordinary.

189 words

2 While you read

5 × 2 pts

Circle the correct option.

1. How did Sibel's friendship with the stranger begin?
 - a They met at work.
 - b A letter was delivered to the wrong address by mistake.
 - c They were introduced by a mutual friend.
 2. Sibel had copied down the pen pal's address _____.
 3. According to the text, the two women met in person within the first year. ☐ Correct ☐ Incorrect
-
4. By the time they finally met, how did the two women feel about each other's lives?
 - a They knew almost nothing about each other.
 - b They were used to knowing everything about each other's lives.
 - c They had completely lost touch.
 5. The text says a small accident can, by chance, turn into something _____.

3 After you read

Write short answers. Then compare with a partner.

1. Find two discourse markers (like 'in the end') in the text. What do they signal to the reader?

2. Do you think stories like this are becoming more or less common because of the internet? Why?
